

3.6.4 Poverty as a social issue

Content	Additional information
• Different interpretations of poverty as a social issue. • The work of Townsend on relative deprivation and Murray on the underclass.	Students should be able to: • identify, describe and explain different interpretations of poverty as a social issue including, the culture of poverty, material deprivation, the way in which governments have attempted to alleviate poverty and unemployment, the impact of globalisation • describe, compare and contrast a variety of sociological perspectives on poverty (functionalist, feminist and Marxist) • describe the key ideas of Townsend (page 53) on relative deprivation • describe the key ideas of Murray (page 52) on the underclass including links to New Right theories.